IDEATION PHASE:

1. Executive Summary

A high-level "elevator pitch" of the project.

- **The Vision:** A brief statement on how the Smart Library System will modernize the user experience (e.g., "Transitioning from manual logs to automated ServiceNow workflows").
- **Key Goals:** Efficiency, 24/7 availability, and data-driven inventory management.

2. Problem Statement & Opportunity Gap

Identify the pain points you are currently solving in your flow.

- **Current Challenges:** Manual approval delays, lost books, or lack of real-time status updates.
- **The Opportunity:** Using automation (like the **Ask for Approval** flow you just built) to reduce the librarian's administrative workload.

3. Stakeholder Analysis

Who interacts with this system?

- **Patrons (Students/Staff):** Want a seamless "Borrow" experience.
- **Librarians:** Need a dashboard to approve requests and track overdue items.
- **IT Admin:** Responsible for the ServiceNow infrastructure and flow maintenance.

4. Proposed Features & Functionality

Break these down into "Must-Haves" and "Nice-to-Haves."

- **Core Features:**
  - Automated Borrowing Workflow (The logic you're building now).
  - Real-time Inventory Database (`u_book` table).
  - Automated Email Notifications for approvals/rejections.
- **Smart Features:**
  - RFID/Barcode integration for physical tracking.
  - AI-based book recommendations based on borrowing history.

5. User Journey Mapping

A narrative or visual step-by-step of how a user interacts with the system:

1. **Discovery:** User searches for a book in the portal.
2. **Request:** User submits a "Borrow Request."

3. **Validation:** Flow checks if the book is available.
4. **Approval:** Request is routed to the Librarian (the step from your screenshot).
5. **Collection:** User receives a notification to pick up the book.

6. High-Level Technical Architecture

A simplified view of the "stack."

- **Platform:** ServiceNow.
- **Logic Engine:** Flow Designer / Workflow Studio.
- **Data Structure:** Custom tables (e.g., `u_book`, `u_borrow_request`).
- **Integrations:** (e.g., LDAP for user login or Outlook for notifications).

7. Success Metrics (KPIs)

How will you know the "Smart Library" is actually smart?

- **Turnaround Time:** Average time from request to approval.
- **Error Rate:** Reduction in manual data entry errors.
- **Usage:** Number of digital requests vs. manual walk-ins.